



Future of speech recognition

Microsoft is giving its speech recognition software in Windows Phone a major upgrade, as per a leaked demo. <http://dgit.in/15yJ8QK>



7 years of Twitter

Analyzing the shifting landscape in Twitter's 7 year journey, putting all the changes in perspective. <http://dgit.in/WYCzsq>

The Original Act Fights Back



Experts were convinced that Ultrabooks would usher in the death of laptops as we know them. Present day reality – not even close

Vishal Mathur
vishal.mathur@thinkdigit.com

When ultrabooks began gaining popularity a couple of years ago, quite a few techies with rather inflated self-opinions had prophesied the death of the laptop as we know it. Now, as we sit and analyse the laptops

we've received for this comparison test, and look at them from the perspective of reader queries that regularly trickle in, the reality is far from that prediction. Not only have laptops survived the initial onslaught of their sleeker cousins, but they don't seem to be going anywhere anytime soon. The primary reason being that laptops can offer better performance than the ultrabooks, because of the flexibility in terms of the specifications and the greater room for risk taking thanks to the power package. The ultrabooks, despite their good points, are bound by fairly strict guidelines, dictating almost every-

thing about their existence. But, the rigid guidelines the ultrabooks work with mean that they have a huge advantage in terms of battery life.

Introducing the test

We have 25 of the latest laptops pitted against each other. The criteria for this test was to compare all laptops priced between ₹30,000 and ₹70,000. All major manufacturers are participating in this test, with their latest notebook. All tested notebooks are divided into smaller categories — that is price blocks of ₹10,000 each, to make your buying choice simpler, based on the budget you've set out,

after a like-for-like comparison. Approximate market prices are used to give you an up-to-date picture.

Build & Design

While the general perception is that most laptops look the same, trust us when we say that they don't! In their own way, minor or major, they're all different from each other. First, we'll look at the build and design elements of each laptop – the good and the bad!

Category 1:

₹30,000 - ₹39,999

We have eight laptops in this price band, for which there are